

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
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Theme:

A RELUCTANCE TO CROSS OVER JORDAN



Numbers 32:1-12 (NIV) The Reubenites and Gadites, who had very large herds and flocks, saw that the lands of Jazer and Gilead were suitable for livestock.

2 So they came to Moses and Eleazar the priest and to the leaders of the community, and said,

4 the land the LORD subdued before the people of Israel--are suitable for livestock, and your servants have livestock.

*5 If we have found favor in your eyes," they said, "let this land be given to your servants as our possession. **Do not make us cross the Jordan.**"*

DO NOT MAKE US CROSS THE JORDAN.

▼ JORDAN, MEANS DIFFERENT THINGS TO DIFFERENT PEOPLE.

- In the Negro Spirituals (songs) of America - '*Crossing over Jordan*' - meant Death.
- To some Christians it meant water baptism - the burial of the old life and rising in new life.
- To Israel *Jordan* meant the leaving behind the old and entering into a new life in a new land that God had chosen for them.
- This meant a life of faith (trust) and obedience to God in a new way in a new land with all its challenges etc.
- It was entering into that which God had promised and prepared for them.
- Crossing over *Jordan* meant taking possession of something which already belonged to them (their inheritance given by God) and for the FIRST TIME, taking ownership they could call THEIRS. (They had own nothing in Egypt).

▼ IN TODAY'S SOCIETY we have those who express a similar attitude to that of Reuben and Gad.

In affect

- ▼ THEY WANTED AN INHERITANCE WITHOUT EFFORT! (No fighting, no faith, no obedience).
- ▼ THEY WANTED A BLESSING WITHOUT A COST! (something for nothing).
- ▼ IT WAS LIKE DESIRING A CROWN WITHOUT A CROSS!

Quotes

◆ Christianity

A cheap Christianity without a cross will prove in the end a useless Christianity without a crown.

◆ The cross life

There can be no meal without a mill, no throne without a thorn, no gain without pain, and no crown without a cross.

♦ **Discipleship:**

Cost: Salvation is free, but discipleship costs everything we have.

■ CHRISTIANITY is often presented and viewed in such a way that it's primary purpose is for the pleasure of man. What man can gain or benefit from the gospel.

* BE CAREFUL that you are not influenced by such a philosophy.

WHAT IS **OUR JORDAN**?

▼ WHAT IS THAT THING IN OUR LIVES THAT WE DON'T WANT TO CROSS OVER TO THE OTHER SIDE?

▼ THAT ITEM THAT WE DON'T WANT TO FACE OR TRANSITION FROM WHERE WE ARE NOW TO WHERE GOD WANTS US TO BE?

* **Jordan** can be our reluctance to surrender our COMFORT levels, of having to face discomforts, inconveniences.

* It can also be our belief that we are not tough /strong enough to engage in those things.

* For others their Jordan is their fear of the risk factor associated with stepping out for God.

* And for some it is a reluctance to be engaged in the battle; they don't like confrontation and conflict, they desire to be loved by everybody rather than contending or fighting for something related to God's will – this is their Jordan that they don't want to cross over.

▼ **JORDAN FOR OTHERS** IS THEIR FEAR OF LOSS.

* Loss if they step out for God into the unknown and they are not prepared to make that transition of crossing over. E.G. Afraid of the loss of their free will to make their own decisions, loss of their position, loss of prestige and acclaim, loss of financial gain/support

■ The following list expresses the same attitude of Reuben and Gad in their refusal to cross over Jordan and enter into what God had prepared as an inheritance for them.

1. **WANTING** HEALING WITHOUT EFFORT. (No prior preparation of self in the Word of God. Example – how the woman who touched Jesus' garment had prepared herself prior to seeking healing – for she said within herself if I can touch the hem of his garment, I shall be made whole.

2. **DESIRING** ANSWERS WITHOUT SEEKING AND WAITING ON GOD. (we want Instant results, answers NOW).

3. **WANTING** FORGIVENESS WITHOUT REPENTANCE.

4. **WANTING** FRUIT WITHOUT THE EFFORT OF SOWING.

5. **EXPECTING** A HARVEST WITHOUT SOWING IN TEARS. THE TEARS OF COMPASSIONATE PRAYER AND INTERCESSION.

Psalm 126:6 He that goeth forth and weepeth, bearing precious seed, shall doubtless come again with rejoicing, bringing his sheaves with him. KJV

6. **WANTING** OTHERS TO CHOOSE AND DECIDE FOR US. It's easier to go with the flow – rather than think and reason for ourselves what is right or wrong according to God's Word. It is least likely of being to be blamed or criticized.

▼ **HAPPY TO FOLLOW**, BUT NOT TO LEAD, expressing a refusal to accept responsibility, or to be accountable for actions or decisions made.

▼ **PREPARED TO ENDORSE AND SUPPORT** some project or vision BUT NOT to become personally involved.

PEOPLE TODAY ARE AFRAID TO MAKE LONG TERM COMMITMENT TO ANYTHING, because it seriously reduces or restricts their future "choices" and options. They feel that it marginalizes them in the way people see them. There is less thought given as to what God may want from them.

► WHAT IS **YOUR JORDAN** THAT YOU ARE RELUCTANT OR REFUSING TO CROSS OVER AND EXPLORE THOSE THINGS THAT GOD HAS PREPARED FOR YOU ON THE OTHER SIDE?

● Is it healing or deliverance your Jordan that needs to be crossed?

● Is your Jordan your failure to fully possess your inheritance that was purchased for you through Christ?

● Is it passed hurts and offences that is your Jordan that needs to be crossed over so that restoration can take place?

● Is it forgiveness and offering reconciliation to those broken human relationships – amongst brethren, families and marriage?

■ **MAY WE BE A PEOPLE THAT ARE PREPARED TO CROSS OVER "OUR JORDANS" WHATEVER THEY MIGHT BE AND TRANSITION INTO ALL THAT GOD HAS PROMISED AND PREPARED FOR US.**

■ On the other side of Jordan is Beulah land (married to the Lord) – the promised land – your possession- yet unclaimed. Amen – Ps Barry